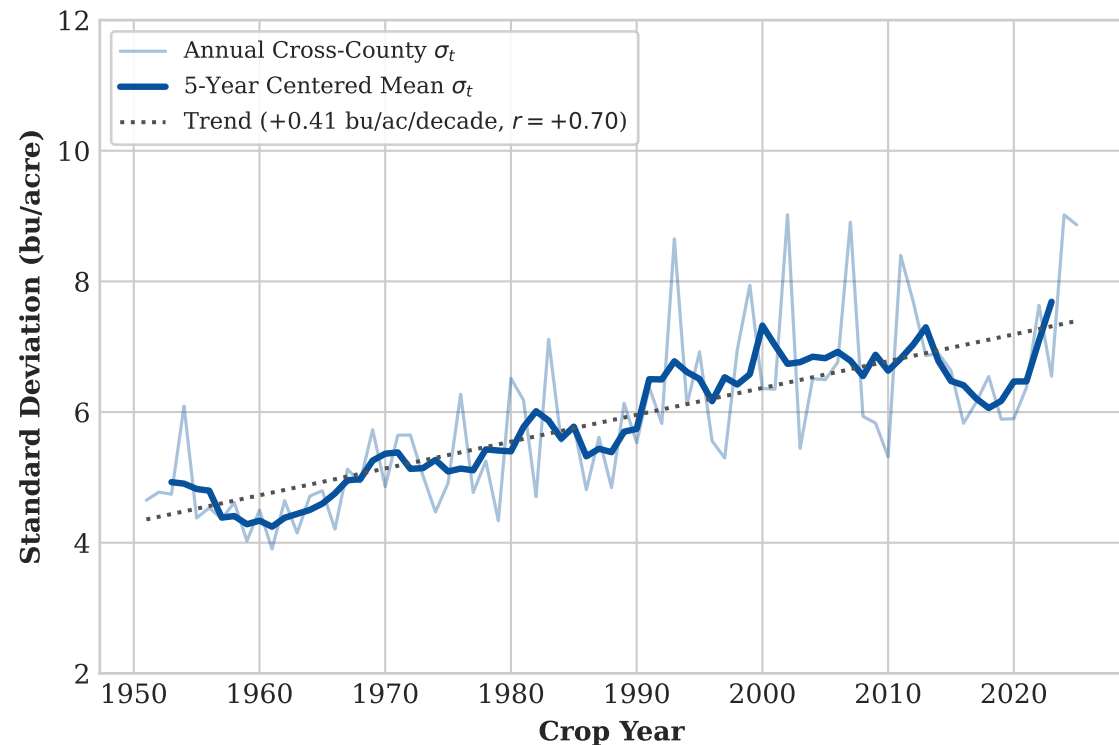


Dispersion Dynamics: Rising Absolute Variance vs. Declining Relative Volatility (1951--2025)

(a) Absolute Cross-County Dispersion (σ_t)



(b) Relative Volatility (CV_t)

